



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's travel to Tibet!



Learning Outcome

Understand detailed descriptions of real or imaginary events and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about Tibetan culture?
- What do you think people need to achieve a state of inner peace?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about different cultures and civilizations.
- I can talk about unusual events in the past.
- I can skim and scan a text for important information.





Let's Explore!

Eating in Tibet can be **monotonous***.

* "Monotonous" means boring because it does not change.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Entering Tibet, you feel as though you've just entered an entirely different world. The traditional Tibetan culture has remained strong until now and is central to the region. Northern Tibet, or Amdo is home to the nomadic people. Huge grasslands typify the area. It also maintains a rich culture. To the north, you can find numerous interesting monasteries. Eastern Tibet, or Kham is mountainous with deep valleys where swift rivers run through. Both areas are wonderful to explore. Here, the original Tibetan culture has survived unchanged so far, unlike the culture in the big cities of modern Tibet. Up to now, these areas have not required permits to visit.

Tourism in Tibet is now strictly controlled by the Chinese government. This means that tourists have recently had to start traveling with organized trips. They haven't been allowed to travel on an independent basis. Have you thought of trying to go off on your own? If you haven't yet, don't. There are checkpoints everywhere. You may even be stopped or questioned by the Chinese police.

Eating in Tibet can be monotonous. The diet is largely limited to barley with mutton or yak and dairy products. There are few spices or vegetables, except for a brutally hot chili sauce often served on the side. Stop in a Chinese restaurant for an excellent wider variety of food. The Tibet experience is still worth dealing with the permits and restrictions. I've only just returned and would not have missed any of it for the world!





Let's Practice!

Tibet is beautiful.

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

has remained / so far / required / now / survived / returned / just /
Up to now / entered / saw

1. You've just _____ an entirely different world.
2. Tibetan culture has _____ unchanged _____.
3. I've only _____ to Tibet.
4. Tibetan culture _____ strong until _____.
5. _____, these areas have not _____ permits to visit.
6. We visited Kham and _____ deep valleys with swift rivers.



Let's Practice!

Before you go on a trip, you should always get the right information.

Instructions: Match the part of the sentence in column A with the corresponding in column B.

COLUMN A

1. Entering Tibet you feel as though
2. Northern Tibet, or Amdo is
3. Eastern Tibet, or Kham is
4. Eating in Tibet can be
5. The Tibet experience is still worth dealing with

COLUMN B

- a. _____ mountainous with deep valleys.
- b. _____ the permits and restrictions.
- c. _____ you've just entered an entirely different world.
- d. _____ monotonous.
- e. _____ home to the nomadic people.



Extension Activity

Talk about Tibetan food.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library to find out about Tibetan food.
- Write down 5 or 6 different dishes and what they are made of.
- Look at the pictures and ingredients think about whether you would find the food appetising or not.
- Write notes explaining why you feel this way.
- Take your notes on the dishes to class and talk about them.
- Say what you think of this type of food and ask for others' opinions.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I go online or to the library to find out about Tibetan food.

☐ ☐

I write down 5 or 6 different dishes and what they are made of.

☐ ☐

I write notes explaining why I feel the food is or is not appetising.

☐ ☐

I take my notes to class and talk about the food.

☐ ☐

I ask others' opinions on it.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- region** (noun): area
e.g. The traditional Tibetan culture has remained strong until now and is central to the region.
- grasslands** (noun): large flat areas with tall grass
e.g. Huge grasslands typify the area.
- monastery** (noun): a building where monks live and worship
e.g. To the north, you can find numerous interesting monasteries.
- swift** (adjective): very fast
e.g. Kham is mountainous with deep valleys where swift rivers run through.
- unchanged** (adjective): remaining as it always has been
e.g. Here, the original Tibetan culture has survived unchanged so far.
- permit** (noun): a paper allowing you to do something
e.g. Up to now, these areas have not required permits to visit.
- independent** (adjective): without being supervised
e.g. They haven't been allowed to travel on an independent basis.





Learning Points

Present Perfect for Unusual Events

You use the **Present Perfect** tense in variety of ways.

In a story, you can use it to:

- refer to events that happened very recently. In these cases, you use words like *just*, *only just* and *recently*.

For example:

*Entering Tibet you feel as though **you've just entered** an entirely different world.*

You can use the **Present Perfect** in questions to ask about past experience or unusual events:

- notice the use of the word *ever* in questions.

You can use words such as *yet*, *up to now*, *so far* and *until now* when you use the **Present Perfect**, since these words and phrases refer to a period of time covering the past to the present.

For example:

***Up to now**, these areas have not required permits to visit.*

*The traditional Tibetan culture has remained strong **until now** and is central to the region.*

*Here, the original Tibetan culture has survived unchanged **so far**.*

*If you haven't **yet**, don't.*

(You use *yet* in negative statements and in questions).

Examples:

- *You feel as though **you've just entered** an entirely different world.*
- *The traditional Tibetan culture **has remained** strong until now.*
- *The original Tibetan culture **has survived** unchanged so far.*
- *Up to now, these areas **have not required** permits to visit.*
- *Tourists **have** recently **had** to start travelling with organised trips.*
- *They **haven't been** allowed to travel on an independent basis.*
- ***Have** you ever **thought** of trying to go off on your own?*
- *I've only just **returned**.*





Learning Points

Skimming and Scanning a Text

Skimming and scanning are two very different strategies for reading texts quickly and for getting the information you need from them without wasting time. Knowing when to use these skills will help with your reading abilities and comprehension skills.

Skimming:

Skimming refers to looking only for the **general or main ideas** in a text.

When you skim, your overall understanding is reduced because **you don't read everything**. You read only what is important to your purpose.

One technique for effective skimming is **reading only the first line of each paragraph**, since these are the topic sentences which will give you some clues about what the main idea of each paragraph is.

Scanning:

Scanning refers to looking for **specific information** in a text. Examples of scanning in daily life are: bus schedules, movie schedules, phone lists, etc. When you use these kinds of texts, you are only looking for a specific detail (a number, a date, a name, etc.).

Knowing the structure of the text you want to scan will help you do it quickly (alphabetical, numerical, categorical, chronological).

Try skimming and scanning the text for the general ideas and for specifics.

Examples:

- *Entering Tibet you feel as though you've just entered an entirely different world.*
- *Northern Tibet, or Amdo is home to the nomadic people.*
- *Eastern Tibet, or Kham is mountainous with deep valleys.*
- *Eating in Tibet can be monotonous.*
- *The Tibet experience is still worth dealing with the permits and restrictions.*

